

SERVICE MANAGEMENT

in CRM

Research Document

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1. What Is Service Management?

Service Management is the process of handling everything that happens after a customer purchases a product or service. Its goal is to ensure customers receive timely support, repairs, maintenance, installations, replacements, and assistance throughout the product's lifecycle.

Illustrative Example

A customer buys an air conditioner. Six months later, the unit stops cooling. The customer contacts support, a complaint is logged, a technician is assigned and dispatched, the unit is repaired, the customer provides feedback, and the request is closed.

This end-to-end process is what constitutes Service Management.

1. Customer buys product
2. AC stops cooling
3. Customer contacts support
4. Complaint created
5. Technician assigned
6. Technician repairs unit
7. Customer feedback
8. Request closed

2. Why Is Service Management Important?

A CRM system is not limited to managing customers and sales — it must also manage post-sale customer support. A robust Service Management module delivers the following benefits:

- Better customer satisfaction
- Faster issue resolution
- Better technician management
- Complete service history
- Warranty tracking
- Improved business insights
- Higher customer retention

3. Service Management Workflow

At a high level, every service interaction follows a consistent sequence from initial customer contact through to closure:

1. Customer raises complaint / service request
2. Customer support receives the request
3. Request assigned to a technician
4. Technician visits the customer
5. Problem is fixed
6. Invoice / warranty check performed
7. Customer feedback collected
8. Service closed

4. Industries That Use Service Management

Service Management principles apply across a wide range of industries, each with its own service types and support needs:

Industry	Typical Services
Home Appliances	Air conditioners, refrigerators, washing machines, televisions, RO water purifiers — installation, repair, maintenance
Electronics	Mobile repair, laptop repair, printer repair, CCTV installation
Automobile	Car service, bike service, vehicle maintenance
Internet Service Providers	Broadband installation, internet repair, router replacement
Healthcare	Medical equipment maintenance
Software Companies	Customer support, bug reports, technical support, software maintenance
E-commerce	Wrong product, damaged product, missing product, replacement, refund

5. Main Modules of Service Management

5.1 Customer Management

Stores core customer information used throughout the service lifecycle.

- Customer name
- Phone number
- Email
- Address

5.2 Complaint Management

Used when customers report problems with a product or service. Each complaint record captures key details needed for resolution.

- Complaint number
- Customer
- Product
- Issue
- Priority
- Status
- Description

Sample complaints:

AC not cooling • TV not working • Wrong product delivered • Internet not working

5.3 Service Request

Not every request is a complaint — many are planned or proactive service activities.

- Product installation
- Product demo
- Preventive maintenance
- Inspection
- Regular service

5.4 Work Order

A Work Order is created once a service request has been approved, assigning the job to a specific technician with a scheduled visit.

Work Order — Repair AC

Customer: Rahul Sharma | Technician: Amit Kumar | Visit: Tomorrow, 10:00 AM

5.5 Technician Management

Maintains a complete profile of each technician for effective job assignment.

- Skills
- Availability
- Assigned jobs
- Current status
- Contact details

5.6 Scheduling

Coordinates and books customer visits against technician availability.

Example Visit

Visit Date: 25 July | Time: 10:00 AM

5.7 Field Service Management

Supports technicians working on-site at customer locations with mobile-enabled tools.

- GPS tracking
- Route navigation
- Photo upload
- Customer signature capture
- OTP verification
- Mark job complete

5.8 Warranty Management

Determines whether a repair is covered under warranty or chargeable.

Warranty Valid → Free Repair

Warranty Expired → Paid Service

5.9 Spare Parts Management

Tracks spare parts consumed during repair and service activities.

- Compressor
- Fan
- Motor
- PCB
- Gas cylinder

5.10 Inventory Management

Tracks the movement of stock from warehouse to technician to end customer.

Stock Flow

Warehouse → Technician → Customer

5.11 Billing

Generates invoices once a service is completed, consolidating all applicable charges.

- Labour charges
- Spare parts cost
- Tax
- Discounts
- Total amount

5.12 Customer Feedback

Captures the customer's experience once the service is completed.

★★★★★

"Technician arrived on time and fixed the issue quickly."

6. Complaint Lifecycle

A complaint progresses through a well-defined set of stages from creation to closure, ensuring accountability at every step:

1. Complaint created
2. Assigned
3. Technician accepted
4. Travelling
5. Reached customer
6. Inspection
7. Repair
8. Testing
9. Completed
10. Customer approval
11. Closed

7. Complaint Priority

Complaints are classified by priority to ensure the most urgent issues receive attention first:

Priority	Example
Critical	Hospital equipment failure
High	AC stopped working in summer
Medium	Regular maintenance
Low	General enquiry

8. User Roles

Service Management involves several distinct roles, each with clearly defined responsibilities:

Role	Responsibilities
Customer	Raise complaints, track service, view history, give feedback
Customer Support	Create complaints, communicate with customers, update service requests

Role	Responsibilities
Technician	Accept jobs, visit customers, update work status, upload photos, complete service
Service Manager	Assign technicians, monitor work, handle escalations, view reports
Inventory Manager	Manage spare parts, issue stock, track inventory
Administrator	Manage users, configure CRM, view analytics, manage permissions

9. Example Workflows

9.1 AC Repair

1. Customer's AC stops cooling
2. Customer raises complaint
3. Support creates ticket
4. Technician assigned
5. Technician visits home
6. Gas refilled
7. Warranty checked
8. Invoice generated
9. Customer gives rating
10. Case closed

9.2 Online Grocery

1. Customer receives damaged milk
2. Complaint raised
3. Replacement approved
4. Delivery partner assigned
5. New product delivered

6. Complaint closed**9.3 Software Company****1. Customer reports login issue****2. Support ticket created****3. Engineer assigned****4. Bug fixed****5. Customer confirms****6. Ticket closed**

10. Service Management Within the CRM

Service Management operates as one of several interconnected pillars inside a complete CRM platform:

- Customer Management
- Sales Management
- Product Management
- Complaint Management
- Service Requests
- Work Orders
- Technician Management
- Scheduling
- Field Service
- Warranty
- Inventory
- Billing
- Customer Feedback
- Reports & Analytics

11. Key Benefits

- Improves customer satisfaction
- Faster complaint resolution

- Better technician productivity
- Complete service history
- Efficient inventory tracking
- Warranty management
- Better reporting and analytics
- Increases customer retention

12. Conclusion

Service Management is a core CRM module that manages all customer support activities after a sale. It connects customers, complaints, technicians, work orders, warranties, inventory, billing, and feedback into one complete workflow.

A well-designed Service Management module helps businesses deliver faster, more organised, and customer-friendly support while improving operational efficiency and long-term customer relationships.